



24 | A: If at all, AI will enhance the right skills needed. In Q2 of FY26, we were the first in our industry to report \$100 million in AI revenue. That underscores our strength and depth of our strategy and being relevant to our customers. We have got a range of solutions for AI: AI Force, AI Foundry, AI Engineering and AI Factories, and AI Labs. A lot of work being done there is by upskilling our people and making them future-ready. Plus, we are creating proprietary IPs, which unlock this intelligence layer that is built by hyperscalers as most customers are working with them. That also forges a much more strategic partnership across the ecosystem.

Q: What is your vision for HCLTech for the next decade? Which new geographies are you looking at to expand the business?

A: In the tech business, a decade is a lifetime. Over the next couple of years, in terms of geographies, the largest for us and the industry are the US and Europe. We continue to double down on those. In Europe, we continue to invest in the UK and Germany. In terms of newer geographies, Japan, India and the Middle East are a big focus. At present, HCLTech's revenues from India are less than 3% of global revenues. We hope to build that business as well. New geographies take longer to build.

“Hiring is a function of the demand environment. That is driven by what is happening globally, as most of our industry is export-oriented. I think it is going to improve from hereon”

Q: What are the biggest challenges and opportunities for the Indian IT industry today?

A: I think some challenges that are prevalent in the world are in some ways advantages for our industry. Even though there are geopolitical headwinds and tariffs, the growth of global capability centres (GCCs) is not slowing in India. A lot of customers look at India as a talent base for the world. What tariffs will do to a lot of industries is drive up costs. Then, cost efficiencies and investment in technology will become very important. That means demand for firms such as